A search tool for the examples in Kant's logic

Judgements, immediate inferences, syllogisms and their kin in Meier's Auszug, Kant's Reflexionen on it, and the logic lectures: a brief

Kant Lab · prepared for Nik Land · 23 October 2026 · All counts below were taken from the repository as it stands today.

The short answer. Build it as a **curated catalogue of examples with a search page over it**, not as a cleverer search over the raw text. You have most of the foundations already: your three explorers hold 232 hand-classified examples in three similar but different shapes.

1. **Merge** the three files into one catalogue with one schema, anchored to the shared `data/` files and never copying their text.
2. **Build one page** over it, with facets for kind of form, source, date, instance or rule, and attested or inferred.
3. **Add the sources that are missing.** The catalogue has nothing yet from Meier himself, no judgements or syllogisms from the Reflexionen, and nothing from Jäsche.
4. **Grow coverage with machine-proposed candidates** that a person accepts in the page. Patterns come first, then a language-model pass if you want one. Nothing a machine proposes counts as an example until someone has checked it.

1 Why not just search the texts?

A keyword search finds where Kant names a form, not where he gives an example of one. Even where it finds the right passage, it cannot classify what it finds, because the texts name only part of the classification. Your own catalogue measures this:

- Of the 52 judgements in `judgement-examples.js`, the transcript names **all** of the judgement's moments for only **7**. For the rest, at least one moment was assigned by you from the sentence's form.
- Of the 95 judgements written down inside the immediate-inference entries, the text states the A/E/I/O form of only **15**.
- Of the 79 inference entries, 16 name neither their kind nor their form. Of the 44 that give a concrete instance, 10 name nothing.

So the classification is scholarly work, and it has to be **stored and shown as yours**. It cannot be recomputed on every page load, which is what the existing keyword tools do: mikrishnan's *Types of judgment* tab, Aidan's judgment finder. Those tools stay useful as *feeders* that point to passages worth reading.

The figures also show a bias worth knowing about. In 48 of the 52 judgement entries the text names at least one of the moments, and in 74 of the 101 immediate-inference entries it names the kind of inference. The catalogue was gathered mostly where the lectures discuss the forms. The examples Kant drops in passing elsewhere, in the chapters on certainty, concepts and method, are the ones a candidate pass (§ 6) is for.

2 What already exists

Asset	Where	What it contributes
Judgement explorer	`Individuals/Nik Land/`	52 judgements (Blomberg 9, Busolt 17, Wiener 26); the four moments, with `stated` recording which moments the text names
Inference explorer	`Individuals/Nik Land/`	79 inferences (Blomberg 23, Busolt 42, Wiener 14): `kind`, `level` (44 instances, 35 rules), `form`, `named`, `faulty`
Immediate inferences	`Individuals/Nik Land/`	101 entries (Blomberg 16, Busolt 24, Wiener 20, **Reflexionen 41**); each judgement has a role and an A/E/I/O form; readers can flag entries, saved to `miscategorisations.js`
Logik concordance	`Individuals/Nik Land/`	Lecture passages, Reflexionen and Jäsche aligned to each Meier §, which the compare views need (§ 5)
Jäsche *Logik*	`logic-jaesche-9.js`	AA IX in the lectures' shape: 862 blocks, about 40,000 words
Mediate inferences	`Individuals/Sophia Wyatt/`	38 more, including 9 fallacies, 2 enthymemes, an induction and an analogy
Judgment finder	`Individuals/Aidan/`	Automatic: finds simple example sentences and labels each *named*, *premise/conclusion* or *speculated*. A ready-made candidate source
Logic corpus	`Individuals/mikrishnan/`	A lecture reader with spelling-folded search (*Urteil* finds *Urtheil*), worth reusing in the new page
Meier's text	`Individuals/maria/`, `Jesus-La-Paz/`	Copied twice out of the Meier reader. **It is not yet in `data/`**, and Maria already has the extractor for it

3 The corpus

Source	Edition	Size	Where the examples concentrate	Catalogued
Meier, *Auszug* (1752)	AA XVI	563 §§ · 39k words	§§ 292–352 *Urtheile*, §§ 353–413 *Vernunftschlüsse*. 83 §§ use *z. E.* or *Exempel*: 11 in the judgement chapter, 21 in the inference chapter	0
Reflexionen on Meier	AA XVI	1,870 · 91k words	158 on §§ 292–352, 126 on §§ 353–413, about 14k words together. That is a few sittings' reading by hand	41
Logik Blomberg (c. 1771)	AA 24:7–301	96k words	Keyed to Meier's §§ by its own headings	48
Wiener Logik (1780ff.)	AA 24:785–940	58k words	Aligned to Meier by the concordance	60
Logik Busolt (c. 1789/90)	AA 24:603–686	27k words	Aligned to Meier by the concordance	83
Jäsche, *Logik* (1800)	AA IX	40k words	§§ 17–40 judgements, §§ 41–95 inferences. Optional	0

About 350,000 words in all. That is small enough to read in full by script, and small enough for a language model to read in full, section by section. The figures in the last column are your three files combined, before deduplication: some passages appear in both the inference file and the immediate-inference file.

4 The data: one record per example

Keep the principle your three files already share: **anchor, don't copy.** An entry points at a block, a Reflexion or a Meier § and carries the passage verbatim. The page finds the passage again at load time and works out the AA page from the data's own offsets, so regenerating `data/` cannot leave a stale citation. What changes is that the three shapes become one:

```
{ id: "bus-01", src: "busolt", block: "busolt-s24-006",   // or r: 3177, or meier: 300
  quote: "Alle Menschen sind Sterblich. Dies Urtheil ist ...",  // verbatim
  kind:  ["judgement"],          // a path in the taxonomy below
  level: "instance",             // instance | schema (Alle A sind B) | rule
  lang:  "de",                   // de | la
  parts: [ { t: "Alle Menschen sind Sterblich", role: "example",
             quantity: "universal", quality: "affirmative", relation: "categorical",
             modality: "assertoric", aeio: "A" } ],
  stated: ["quantity","quality","relation","modality"], // named by the text; rest inferred
  stock: "homo-mortalis",        // groups recurrences of a stock example
  faulty: null,                  // or what the lecturer says is wrong with it
  found: "hand",                 // hand | pattern | model
  status: "accepted",            // accepted | proposed | flagged
  checked: "NL 2026-10-16", note: "" }
```

Use one taxonomy, in Kant's own terms, with modern glosses beside them and never in their place. Where Kant's division differs from the modern one it should stay visible: contraposition is his inference *by modality*, and the infinite judgement is a third quality.

- **Urtheil.** Quantity, quality, relation, modality; A/E/I/O; and the further kinds that are still to be settled: analytic and synthetic, exponible, identical, practical.
- **Verstandesschluss** (immediate). By aequipollence and by subalternation; by opposition, whether contradictory, contrary or subcontrary; by conversion, *simpliciter* or *per accidens*; by contraposition.
- **Vernunftschluss** (mediate). Categorical, with figure and mood; hypothetical, *ponens* or *tollens*; disjunctive; the dilemma.
- **Schluss der Urtheilskraft.** Induction and analogy.
- **Composite and abbreviated.** The polysyllogism, with its pro- and episyllogisms; the sorites; the enthymeme; the *ratiocinatio hybrida*.
- **Faulty.** Paralogism, sophism, and the named *fallaciae*.

Keep your existing rule: **a moment the form does not fix is left `null`, not guessed**. The modality of a hypothetical judgement as a whole is the standing example.

5 The page

- **Facets with counts.** These are the taxonomy tree; the source; a date range, using the lecture dates, and for Reflexionen Adickes' phases turned into years by `phaseYears()`; instance, schema or rule; a Meier § range; the language; and an *only what the text names* toggle.
- **Text search within the examples**, using mikrishnan's spelling folding, so that *Urteil* finds *Urtheil*. Add an i/j rule as well: the texts spell *Caius* both ways.
- **Cards.** Each card has the citation (`AA 24:N`, `AA 16:N` with the Reflexion's number, the Meier §) and the quote with the example highlighted. Each judgement in it carries badges for its role and moments: solid where the text names the moment, dashed where you inferred it. Below that are the note and *Open in context*, which goes to the Meier reader for Meier and the Reflexionen, or to a lecture reader.
- **Compare by Meier §.** For one §, a row each for Meier's own example, the Reflexionen in phase order, Blomberg, Wiener, Busolt and Jäsche. This view is what lets the tool say something about the development of Kant's teaching. It needs your concordance.
- **Stock examples.** Every occurrence of one `stock` key, in date order. The exact words *Alle Menschen sind sterblich* occur 22 times in the lectures and the Reflexionen. Following that one example, and *Caius ist sterblich* with it, from the Reflexionen through to 1790 is a result in its own right.
- **Flag and review.** Keep the mechanism from the immediate-inferences page, which writes the flag file back to disk in Chrome. Extend it to accept, edit or reject a proposed candidate.
- **Export** the current results as CSV with full citations, for use in a paper.

6 Growing the catalogue

A person reading is what produces a catalogue entry. Machines can only shorten what that person has to read. The process has three stages, and each candidate keeps a record of the stage that found it.

1. **Patterns**, in a Python script in your folder. Each pattern makes the candidate's kind a guess, nothing more:
   - example markers: *z. E.*, *z. B.*, *zum Exempel*, *e. g.*;
   - quantifier frames: *Alle … sind*, *Kein … ist*, *Einige …*, *omnis*, *nullus*;
   - connectives: *wenn … so*, *entweder … oder*;
   - conclusion markers: *also*, *folglich*, *ergo*;
   - letter schemata such as *A ist B*;
   - and Aidan's simple-sentence test.

   The output is `candidates.js`, with `status: "proposed"`.
2. **A model pass, if you want one.** Give the model one section at a time, with the schema and a dozen accepted entries as worked examples, and ask it for candidates in the same shape. A script then **drops any candidate whose quote is not an exact substring** of the block it names. Every field the model fills in is marked inferred until a person confirms it.
3. **Review in the page.** A queue of proposed candidates, each with accept, edit or reject. An accepted candidate becomes `accepted` and keeps its `found`.

Measure before you trust. Your 232 entries are a gold set. Run each stage over the sections they come from, and report how many of them it finds, before using it anywhere else. Because the gold set leans towards passages where the text names the form (§ 1), also check a small hand-read sample from the chapters on certainty and method.

7 Hard cases to decide once

- **Note-form Reflexionen and lecture shorthand** (*u. s. w.*, *etc.*, a conclusion that is never stated). Show them as they stand. If a missing conclusion is supplied, it is supplied as inferred, as `supply` already does.
- **Transcription debris** inside examples, such as `nicht7 °` in `wiener-s12-002`. Display it as printed and search through it; do not clean the quote.
- **One sentence serving two kinds**, such as a dilemma, or a reduction of the second figure. `kind` is a list for this reason.
- **Examples offered as mistakes.** `faulty` records what the lecturer says is wrong, in his words.
- **Latin and German versions of one example** are separate entries that share a `stock` key.

8 Steps, and where the work lives

1 · Merge A migration script turns your three files into `logic-examples.js`. It keeps the ids and carries the flags over. Then a check that every quote is found again in its block. Sophia's 38 come in only with her agreement.

2 · Page `logic-examples.html`, with facets, cards and *Open in context*, plus a `SPEC.md` in the repository's format with numbered, checkable behaviours.

3 · New sources Meier's own examples, starting with the 32 §§ in 292–413 that use *z. E.*; the 284 Reflexionen on §§ 292–413; and Jäsche.

4 · Candidates The pattern script and the review queue, measured against the gold set. A model pass is optional.

5 · Compare The *by Meier §* and *stock example* views.

6 · Share Everything starts in `Individuals/Nik Land/`, where no approval is needed. Then:

- offer it to the **Logic Corpus** group, whose spec is still empty and whose question this tool answers;
- ask Sophia and Maria to put Meier's text into `data/` (and Jäsche too, if wanted);
- eventually, move the catalogue itself into `data/` as a hand-curated file like `tradition-meier.js`, so that the Meier reader can show *examples at this §*.

9 Decisions for you

1. **How far does "etc." reach?** Should definitions and divisions (Meier §§ 249–291) and methods of proof come in, or only judgements and inferences?
2. **One annotator or two?** If two, the schema needs a place for disagreement as well as for `checked`.
3. **A model pass, or patterns only?** If a model pass, is it acceptable that its proposals sit in the repository marked as proposed?
4. **English.** Should the page show translations? Any machine translation has to be labelled as one, as Aidan's page does.
5. **Jäsche.** Is the 1800 *Logik* a source of examples, or only a point of comparison, given that it is Jäsche's compilation?

Sources of the figures. The counts of examples, of stated moments and of named kinds were read from `judgement-examples.js`, `inference-examples.js` and `immediate-inference-examples.js`. The corpus sizes are word counts of the blocks in `data/logik-*-24.js`, `data/reflexionen-16-meier.js` and `logic-jaesche-9.js`. Meier's chapter ranges and his *z. E.* markers were counted from the text in `Individuals/maria/meier-auszug.js`.